

LUNA 9

Lander

On 3 February 1966, three days after its launch, Luna 9 settled gently on Oceanus Procellarum – one of our Moon's biggest maria, or "seas", to become the first spacecraft to complete a successful soft-landing on another world. The probe took many images of the Moon's surface and sent them back to Earth.

Luna 9 proved the Moon's surface could **support the weight of a lander.**

Four "petals" protected Luna 9 during the flight, and opened to stabilize the lander



The Moon as seen by Luna 9

DATA FILE



SIZE: 58 cm (23 in) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 31 January 1966



MISSION DURATION: 7 days (last contact)



SPACE AGENCY: Russian space program